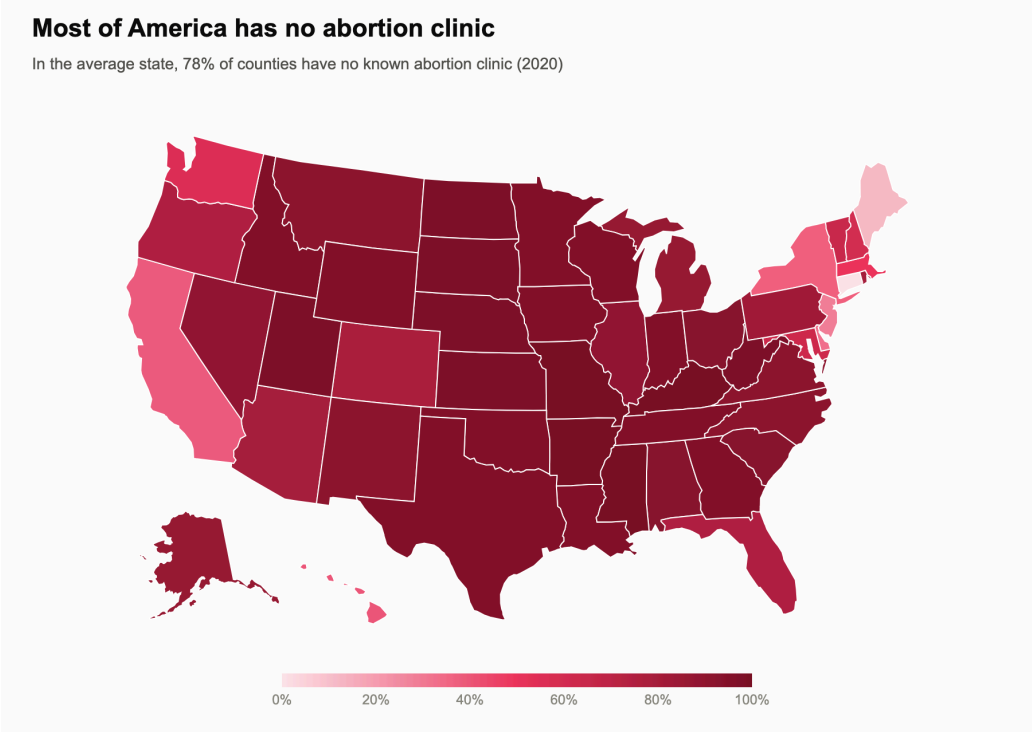
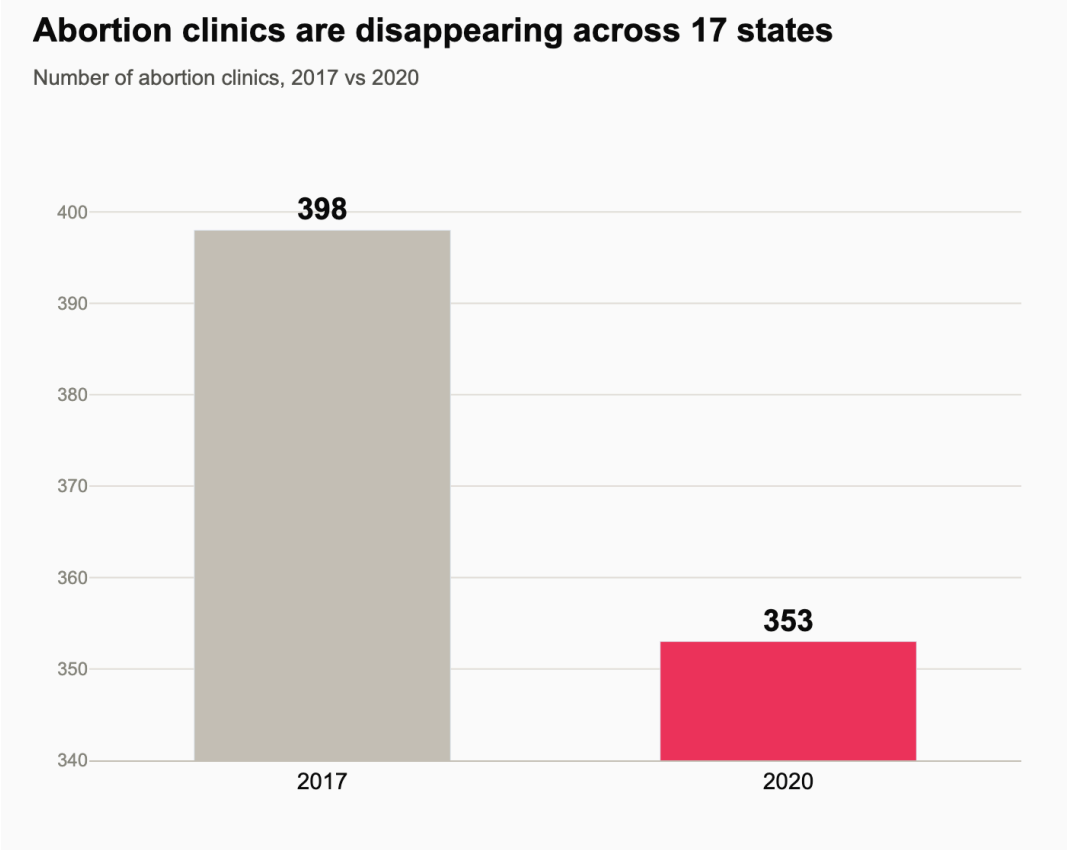
“Pro: access is severely restricted”





“Con: access is not as restricted as it looks”

Most American women live within reach of a clinic

62.5%

of U.S. women aged 15–44 live in a county that has an abortion clinic

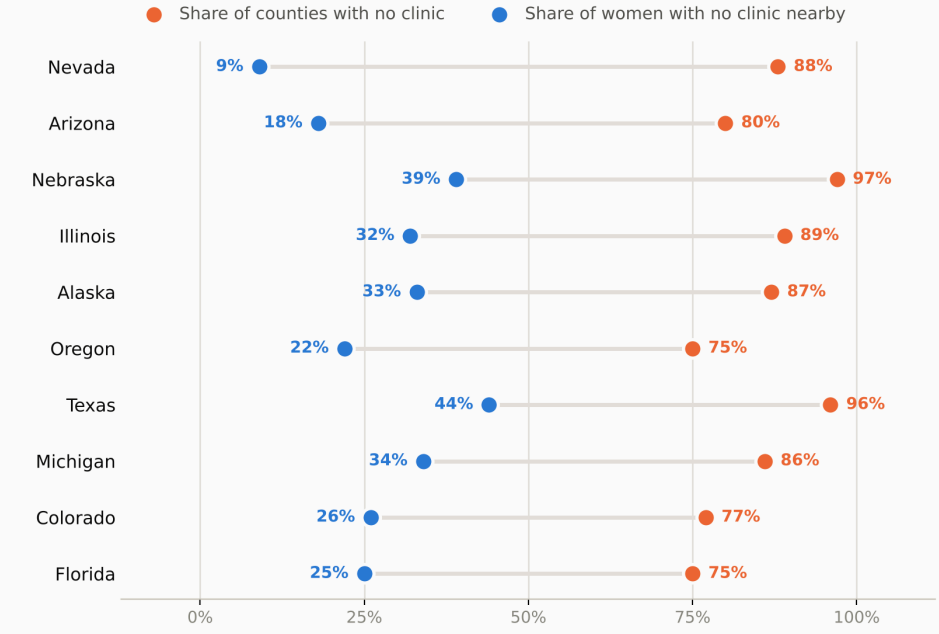


each square = 1% of U.S. women aged 15–44

Population-weighted across all 50 states and DC. Guttmacher Institute, 2020.

Counting counties overstates how many women lack access

Counties are mostly rural and nearly empty; women live in cities. The ten states where the two measures diverge most.



Guttmacher Institute, 2020.

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Proposition

- Access to abortion care in the United States is severely restricted
- **Pro side:** access is restricted because clinics are scarce
- **Con side:** access is not as restricted as it looks

Which set we're leaning toward

- Pro side, because it is clearer and it has a stronger impression

Deceptive techniques used

Pro chart 1: Most of America has no abortion clinic

- Color: darker red has a higher percentage of the state's counties with no clinic
    - Red signifies danger or a warning, so when the reader sees the visualization, they will notice that access to clinics is being restricted almost in all states.
- Data: percentages of each state's counties with no clinic
    - Counting counties makes it easier to support the proposition because most counties don't have a lot of residents, and clinics are usually in cities.

Pro chart 2: Abortion clinics are disappearing across 17 states

- Y-axis: The y-axis started at 340 instead of 0
    - This makes the difference between 2017 and 2020 look much bigger than it actually is
- Color: the 2017 bar uses gray and 2020 uses red
    - Gray makes the reader see the 2017 bar as neutral compared to the 2020 bar as a danger, which would make the reader see the drop as something alarming rather than just a small change

Con chart 1: Most American women live within reach of a clinic

- Color: each square = 1% of women, blue is used for women who live within reach of a clinic and gray is for women without a clinic

    - Blue makes the reader feel calm and gray is neutral, so it makes the reader focus more on the women who live within reach of a clinic and the gray makes it seem like it's not that big of a deal for women who don't live within reach of a clinic
- Text: 62.5% in blue color, and is the biggest text in the viz
    - This will catch the eye of the reader immediately, and because it is blue, it will be seen as a good thing
    - The chart highlights 62.5% of women who have a clinic vs. 37.5% of those without a clinic

Con chart 2: Counting counties overstates how many women lack access

- Line: lines connected between share of counties with no clinic and the share of women with no clinic nearby
    - This makes the reader notice the gap between the two points which will make them conclude that the restriction from county based numbers are not that serious
- Cherry picking states: only 10 states where the two measures differ the most were chosen to display the chart
    - The 10 states that were chosen are states that have many small counties that have few residents, most residents live in the big cities, so the gaps are large
    - The reader assumes that all states have large gaps like these 10 states, which would make them think that generally most women have access to a clinic